

Yet Peter says Warren was like any normal dad. In fact, for many years his father didn't even go to an office, instead working from the spare room upstairs.

'It wasn't until I was about 25 that I actually realised my father had amassed so much wealth,' said Peter.

Warren Buffett jokingly describes his kids as being members of 'the lucky sperm club'.

However, he was intentional about not letting his wealth spoil his kids, saying he wanted to give them 'enough money so that they would feel they could do anything, but not so much that they could do nothing'.

And he meant it.

Peter told me about his early years when he struggled to afford his mortgage and make ends meet. Even now he won't be getting any of his father's \$US85 billion (\$A110 billion) fortune, and he's totally okay with that.

He drives a Ford, doesn't wear designer clothes and seems genuinely happy with his lot in life.

Okay, so you're probably thinking, 'What an absolute Scrooge McDuck that old man Buffett is!'

Well, the day after I spoke to Peter I had an interview with Warren.

(I wisely decided not to tell him that I named my dog after him.)

There were a million things I could have asked him about (not least for a stock pick), but only one that really mattered:

'What advice did you give to Peter when he was growing up?'

'My investment company, Berkshire Hathaway, is my canvas,' said Buffett.

'It allows me to paint a little every day. I encouraged Peter to find his own canvas. It wasn't money he should focus on—but working out what his passions were that would allow him to tap dance to work each day.'

Peter found his canvas. He went on to become an accomplished composer and producer whose achievements include writing the Emmy Award—